

MILITARY SEALIFT COMMAND N3220526R6063

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

21 April 2026

The following are answers to questions received from potential offerors. The answers provide clarification only and DO NOT constitute an amendment to the solicitation.

1. Please advise if there is a maximum vessel age for this requirement.

ANSWER – There is no maximum age for this requirement.

2. The multiple sources sought for this mission allowed for U.S. or Foreign Flag vessels, but the RFP is a U.S. Flag only requirement. Please be advised that the U.S. Coast Guard (USCG) National Vessel Documentation Center (NVDC), which processes the paper for vessel sales/purchases and reflagging is currently closed due to the DHS partial shutdown. We therefore request that MSC place this procurement in suspense at least until this situation is resolved.

ANSWER – At this time, MSC cannot place this procurement in suspense.

3. Further to Question #2 above, the vessels contemplated for this requirement are likely not eligible for an expedited MSP reflag due to the size, military utility and likely age of the vessel. Therefore, the estimated timeline for reflag is 6-9 months after award. Accordingly, we are requesting that MSC consider adjusting the lay/can window to accommodate reflag vessels.

ANSWER – MSC recognizes estimated time to reflag is 6-9 months; however, due to mission requirements the lay/can window cannot be adjusted.

To use the streamlined process, Owners/Offerors would have to enroll in VTA/VISA with MARAD which may invoke a military utility determination. USCG would need that determination to move quickly, typically 60 days if all is in order, i.e., full set of statutory certs that have been maintained. The actual inspection of the vessel is typically 3 or so days. The key to success is that the vessel is in compliance and in good condition. Recommend reviewing the USCG website for: REFLAG FOREIGN VESSELS specifically, NVIC 1-13 CH 2 and the QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE.

4. Is there any incumbent to this?

ANSWER – No incumbent or current contract.

5. Do we have to bid all four, or can we do just one?

ANSWER – Each Offeror must provide 4 – 6 U.S. flagged vessels to meet the total square footage requirement.

6. The RFP states 4 – 6 vessels per offer, but how many in total do you all need?

ANSWER – Minimum of 4 vessels and a maximum of 6 vessels to meet the total square footage of 12,600 and each vessel has a minimum capacity of 2,100 square feet. The results of the Government’s market research indicated that this requirement could be met by existing commercially available sources.

7. It stipulates U.S. flag – will Marshall Island registered be okay – built by U.S. (it’s a LCU 2000 built by U.S. government and owned by American).

ANSWER – The vessels must be U.S. flagged. Due to the Military Cargo Preference Act of 1904 (10 U.S.C. §2631) U.S flagged vessels must be used before foreign flagged vessels.